

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Business situations can be tricky ...



Learning Outcome

Identify and describe rules and obligations through a wider range of language and expressions in both work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can manage a delicate meeting with an important client.
- I can deal with a difficult client.
- I can talk about jobs and work.

Ask your partner:

- When have you had to deal with a delicate conversation?
- What do you think is most important when approaching a sensitive subject?

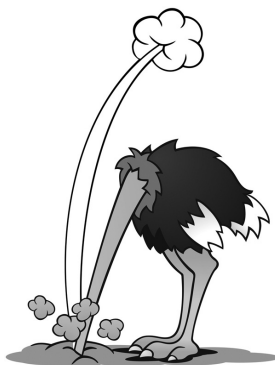




Let's Explore!

Navigating a **sticky situation***.

* A "sticky situation" is a problem or a conflict.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Janet:** Mr. Farmani? This is Janet Ellis, from Polygon. How are you?
- Farmani:** Fine, thank you. How are you?
- Janet:** Well, under the circumstances, Mr. Farmani, I would like to arrange an urgent meeting with you tomorrow if it is possible.
- Farmani:** I have a full schedule tomorrow, but I will accommodate you if this is urgent.
- Janet:** If you could do that, I would appreciate it.
- Farmani:** May I ask you what this is concerning?
- Janet:** We have received a disturbing report about some of Holly's offshore practices. Unfortunately, ethical concerns have hit social media and Holly's is already beginning to face serious image problems. I was wondering whether you were aware of this. If we don't deal with this immediately, there could be boycotts of your product. Petitions have begun.
- Farmani:** I have no idea what you're talking about. What is the source of this report? Is it credible?
- Janet:** If I wasn't certain, I wouldn't have approached you. We have done our own investigation into the facts before contacting you. Concerns have been corroborated.
- Farmani:** Well then, let's schedule tomorrow afternoon to discuss this business. I will rearrange my schedule.
- Janet:** I appreciate that. Miranda will come with me if that's alright.
- Farmani:** Yes. And I'm sure we will be able to work things out.
- Janet:** I believe there are possibilities if we come to an agreement in dealing with these concerns. Mr. Farmani, Polygon is committed to facing this problem if we can work together.
- Farmani:** I am glad to hear that, Janet. I will see you tomorrow.



**Let's Practice!**

A very hypothetical conversation.

Instructions: Proofread the sentences. Correct the sentences. Read them aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. I would like to arrange an urgent meet with you tomorrow if it is possible.

2. I am glad to hearing that, Janet.

3. I have a full schedule tomorrow, but I was accommodate you if this is urgent.

4. I'm not having idea what you're talking about.

5. If we aren't deal with this immediately, there could be boycotts of your product.

6. Miranda does not come with me if that's alright.

**Let's Practice!**

Looks like more bad news for Holly's.

Instructions: Read the sentences to correctly complete them. Use the words provided. Use the sentences to model a conversation with your partner. Switch roles.

1. We have received a disturbing report about some of your company's offshore _____.
(practicums / practice / practices)
2. _____ have begun. (attention / Petition / Petitions)
3. _____ have been corroborated. (Concerns / Concern / Concerning)
4. Well, _____ the circumstances ... (under / over / on)
5. I have a full _____ tomorrow. (schedules / schedule/ scheduling)
6. I will _____ you if this is urgent. (accommodate / accommodation / accomodates)





Extension Activity

Practice how to word things carefully.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Imagine a difficult situation with an important client that you do not wish to offend. What is the client demanding?
- Write down several requests that your client has made politely, using the conditional form.
- Now write down several things that make your situation difficult.
- Add several ways that you will try to accommodate your client.
- Write a back-and-forth dialogue that could occur between you and your client, using these requests and statements with accommodations.
- Read the dialogue together with your partner. Have your partner read the client's lines while you read your own lines about how you will accommodate them.
- Now read your partner's dialogue together.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I make polite requests using the conditional form.

☐
☐

I make verbal accommodations to difficult clients.

☐
☐

I write a realistic dialogue between business partners in a delicate meeting.

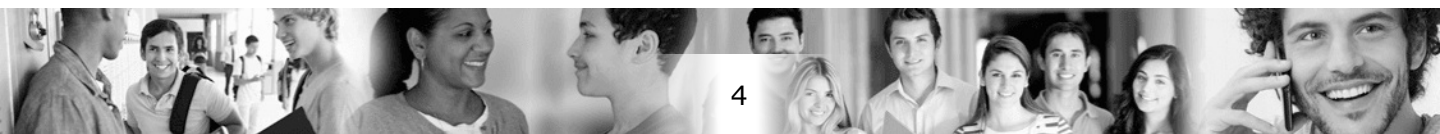
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I read a business partner's expressions of accommodation to a difficult client.

☐
☐


Target Words

- to accommodate** (verb): to fit in with someone's needs or wishes
e.g. I will accommodate you if this is urgent.
- under the circumstances** (expression): even with or because of the way things are at the moment
e.g. I am well, under the circumstances.
- full schedule** (noun): a planned time period that is so busy that nothing more can be planned
e.g. I have a full schedule tomorrow.
- concerning** (preposition): about; related to
e.g. May I ask you what this is concerning?
- offshore practices** (expression): the things a company does regularly outside its own country
e.g. We have received a disturbing report about some of Holly's offshore practices.
- boycott** (noun): a group decision to stop buying products or having any relations with a company
e.g. If we don't deal with this immediately, there could be boycotts of your product.
- petition** (noun): a formal request to make change, with signatures from many people
e.g. Petitions have begun.
- to corroborate** (verb): to confirm; prove true
e.g. Concerns have been corroborated.





Learning Points

Use of *Conditional Tense*

The *Conditional Tense* using 'if' is used when a statement, event or request is dependent on another thing happening. A main clause is followed by an 'if' clause that gives a condition to the first statement.

The *Conditional* is often used to soften what one has to say. In a delicate situation, you don't want to sound demanding or controlling. The *Conditional Tense* is very handy at this time because it makes you sound like you are making a suggestion or request rather than commanding the other person.

Here are two ways to soften what you really want to say with the *Conditional Tense*:

1. You can begin your sentence with the conditional.

Change this original statement:

I want you to come talk with me.

... by adding a condition:

If you are able to leave your work ... please come talk with me.

If it is not too inconvenient ... please come talk with me.

If you don't mind ... please come talk with me.

2. You can add a condition to the end of your statement or request.

Original statement:

I need your help on this project.

Statement with condition:

I need your help on this project if you can ... find the time.

Please come talk with me ... if it's not too much trouble.

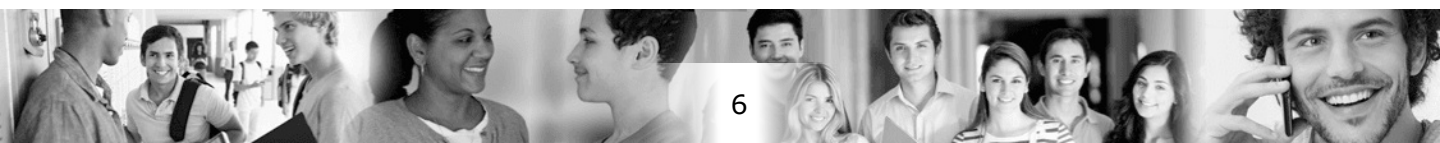
The conditional can also be used to soften an unpleasant statement or prediction by offering a solution. This is done by using 'if' + a negative statement. I.e., "If you don't ... "





Learning Points

Unpleasant or Demanding Statement	Original statement plus condition	Alternative placement of conditional
We must work together.	We must work together if we are going to achieve success.	If we are going to achieve success we must work together.
Our clients will never believe us.	Our clients will never believe us if we don't act now.	If we don't act now, our clients will never believe us.
You might not see her again.	You might not see her again if you don't apologize.	If you don't apologize, you might not see her again.





Learning Points

Dealing with a Difficult Client

At times our clients, coworkers or supervisors may be difficult to work with. Because people often feel more sensitive at these times, language must be worded especially carefully. It is important to communicate that you are listening and open to ideas or suggestions, even if it is not convenient for you.

1. Expressions that show you are listening:

- *Alright/Well then/Okay, let's ...*
- *I hear what you are saying.*
- *I know what you mean.*
- *May I ask what this is concerning?*
- *What would you like from me?*

2. To show you are willing to accommodate someone:

1. Let them know your situation isn't easy
2. Then tell them how you will try to be agreeable

Your situation	How you'll accommodate
I am very busy/The timing is awkward ...	... but I will try to/but I will see what I can do.
Things really aren't ready ...	... but we're working on it/but we'll work on it.
This will be difficult ...	... but I'm sure we can ... work something out/figure something out.
My schedule is full ...	... but I will ... rearrange things for you / see what I can do/make room somewhere.

